



The **PRINCE** of Flip-Flop

On **L.K. ADVANI**

MAY 4 "Before the polls, the BJP began talking of money stashed in Swiss banks. It did nothing when in power."



MAY 5 "Everyone agrees on the Swiss banks. Why don't we work together to bring this money back?"

On **COMMUNISTS**

APRIL 25 "The communists are caught in an ideological bind—an outdated one, which has failed in other places."



MAY 5 "There are many points where we agree with the Left. I am hopeful that it will support a Congress government."

On **NITISH KUMAR**

APRIL 2 "In Bihar, no one gets employment. The state Government revels in keeping its own people backward."



MAY 5 "There are Opposition leaders like Nitish where the intention to work is there. All post-poll options are open."

On **CHANDRABABU NAIDU**

APRIL 10 "Naidu believes that some parts of India can move forward and the rest can be left behind."



MAY 5 "He did a good job as chief minister. He focused on Hyderabad and went on the wrong bend but I respect him."

doors at 10 Janpath by the so-called core group? Instead, it will be announced blithely and spontaneously, and sometimes in the middle of a televised press conference. In the blink of a flashlight, adversaries like Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar and TDP chief Chandrababu Naidu have become worthy of his praise. Even the communists, who did their best but failed to topple the Manmohan Government on the issue of the nuclear

deal, have ceased to be untouchables. "There is a lot of common ground with the Left... I am pretty confident that the Left will support a Manmohan Singh government," he said without a hint of irony as the rest of the party struggled for explanations and Nitish, Naidu and CPI leader A.B. Bardhan spurned his overtures. In the din that followed, few recalled Rahul's reiteration that the Congress would not compromise on Manmohan's candidature

the way it did not compromise on the nuclear deal. "He is a mature politician. What is wrong in praising your opponents if they do good work?," asked media cell chairperson Veerappa Moily with a straight and slightly worried face. It is easy to see why the Congress team of spokespersons looked so perplexed in television studios that evening. It was the same Rahul who blasted the fossils of Kolkata with such panache during his campaign in the state a